■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Sunday, August 02, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

■■ *Canada's new nuclear bet: ditching homegrown fuel for foreign dependence*

The Angle: *After decades of building a totally Canadian nuclear supply chain, Ontario and other provinces are now pivoting to small reactors that need foreign uranium enrichment and processing. It's a major strategic reversal—and raises questions about energy independence.*

- Canada built its **Candu reactor program** around a made-in-Canada supply chain to avoid foreign fuel dependence
- Ontario is currently building **small modular reactors (SMRs)**, with other provinces considering them
- These new SMRs will require **foreign uranium enrichment and fabrication**—a sharp break from decades of Canadian self-reliance

The Strategy Shift

- Is swapping energy independence for smaller reactors worth it, or is Canada handing over control of its own power grid?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/canada-nuclear-supply-chain-smr-darlington-uranium-enrichment-9.7289297?cmp=rss

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■ *Israel says it has 'serious security concerns' over Hamas disarmament deal*

The Angle: *Israel says it has 'serious security concerns' over Hamas disarmament deal*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/israel-hamas-gaza-disarmament-deal-9.7294487?cmp=rss

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■ *As Trump rolls back endangered species protection, experts say Canadian wildlife is also at risk*

The Angle: *As Trump rolls back endangered species protection, experts say Canadian wildlife is also at risk*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/trump-endangered-species-protection-canadian-wildlife-9.7293137?cmp=rss

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■■ *Maduro signals openness to talks while jailed in Venezuela*

The Angle: *Venezuela's imprisoned ex-dictator just opened a door to dialogue with the interim government—a potential turning point after years of brutal conflict. Whether this is genuine negotiation or a tactical move, it's shaking up one of the Western Hemisphere's longest-running political crises.*

- **Nicolas Maduro**, jailed ex-leader of **Venezuela**, announced he welcomes **'any path to dialogue'** with the interim government
- The comments come as **Latin American opposition leaders and Venezuela's interim government** are set to meet
- Maduro's regime has been blamed for **widespread human rights abuses, economic collapse, and mass migration** that destabilized the region

The Real-or-Tactical Question

- Is Maduro genuinely ready to negotiate, or is he playing for time and legitimacy while locked up—and does it even matter if it stops the bleeding?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/jailed-ex-leader-nicolas-maduro-welcomes-any-path-to-dialogue-in-venezuela

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TRENDING TODAY

■ *Washington wildfire forces 5,000 from homes, destroys hundreds*

The Angle: *A fast-moving wildfire in eastern Washington has already destroyed over 600 structures and forced mass evacuations—and crews say it's still uncontained. This is the kind of large-scale disaster that's becoming more frequent across the West, and it's happening right now.*

- **5,000 homes** have been evacuated in eastern Washington state
- **600+ homes, businesses, and buildings** have been destroyed so far
- The fire remained **uncontained** as of Sunday, authorities confirmed

The Reality Check

- How many of you have had to evacuate or know someone who has—and what's the one thing you'd grab if you had 20 minutes to leave?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/wildfires-washington-state-9.7294631?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Yankees pump the brakes on Ben Rice's catching future*

The Angle: *The Yankees just made it clear their promising young catcher Ben Rice won't be their guy behind the plate, even as roster moves create potential logjams at other positions. It's a blunt signal about where the organization sees his role—and his ceiling.*

- **Ben Rice**, the Yankees' young catcher prospect, has **no intention** of seeing regular catching time despite being on the roster
- The addition of **Luis García Jr.** could create a **positional logjam at first base and DH** once the Yankees reach full health
- The move signals the Yankees' commitment to other catching options over Rice's development at that position

The Tough Love Take

- If you're a young prospect and your team straight-up tells you they don't see a future for you at your main position, what do you do—fight for it or accept the writing on the wall?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/02/sports/yankees-have-no-intention-to-play-ben-rice-at-catcher-despite-potential-logjam/

Backup options:

■ *Phil Collins on his toughest battle: saying goodbye to his kids*

The Angle: *The Genesis legend just opened up about a deeply personal moment during his health crisis—and it's hitting people hard. At 75, he's also talking about what comes next in his life, including love.*

- **Phil Collins**, 75, recalled a **heartbreaking goodbye** with his children during a period of **life-threatening health issues**
- The legendary **Genesis drummer** has faced serious health challenges in recent years that forced him to step back from music

- Collins is now **open to a fourth marriage** and says he wants **to be in love again**

The Real Talk Moment

- Have you ever had to have a conversation with someone you love thinking it might be the last one—and how did it change your perspective on what matters?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/celebrity-news/phil-collins-recalls-heartbreaking-goodbye-from-kids-during-life-threatening-health-issues/

■ *Ariana Grande steps back from West End role amid health concerns*

The Angle: *The pop star is pulling out of her London theater debut just weeks before opening night, citing a need to step away from the spotlight. It comes after months of public speculation and commentary about her appearance and weight loss.*

- **Ariana Grande** has withdrawn from her **West End debut** role
- The decision comes after the singer faced **intense scrutiny over her health and physical appearance** in recent months
- She's cited a need to take **a step back from the limelight** as the reason for her exit

The Real Talk

- How much of a celebrity's personal health should be fair game for public commentary—and where's the line between concern and invasion of privacy?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/celebrity-news/ariana-grande-pulls-out-of-west-end-debut-as-she-takes-step-back-from-limelight-after-weight-loss-concerns/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *House of the Dragon star breaks down that wild dream sequence*

The Angle: *Gayle Rankin, who plays Alys Rivers on HBO's hit prequel series, is opening up about one of season two's most jaw-dropping moments—and she's got a surprisingly fun take on what went down behind the scenes.*

- **Gayle Rankin** plays **Alys Rivers** in House of the Dragon
- The scene in question involves **Aemond, Alicent, and Alys** in a dream sequence
- **Rankin** described the scene as **"very absurd"** and **"fun and funny"** to film
- The scene addresses whether **Aemond and Alys have consummated their relationship**

The Casting Couch Question

- What's the weirdest scene you've ever had to act out for a paycheck—and did you laugh or cringe the whole time?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/08/02/house-of-the-dragon-season-3-episode-7-aemond-dreams-of-having-sex-with-mom-alicent-is-really-sleeping-with-alys-rivers/

Backup options:

■ *Marvel's 'Wonder Man' canceled after one season—here's why*

The Angle: *Disney just killed the **Wonder Man** series after its debut, and the showrunner is opening up about what went wrong behind the scenes. It's a rare peek into how Marvel actually makes those cancellation calls.*

- **Andrew Guest**, the showrunner, publicly addressed the cancellation and thanked fans for their support
- The series was canceled despite showing audience success metrics
- Guest provided insight into the decision-making process behind the surprise ax

The Hot Take

- Is Marvel canceling shows too fast, or do we just not know how to measure what actually works on streaming anymore?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/wonder-man-showrunner-discusses-shows-sudden-cancellation-2000793742

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 0/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 1/3 this month)

■ *'90 Day Fiancé': Thomas threatens to call off wedding to Paula for this insane reason*

The Angle: *'90 Day Fiancé': Thomas threatens to call off wedding to Paula for this insane reason*

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/entertainment/90-day-fiance-thomas-threatens-to-call-off-wedding-to-paula-over-insane-reason/

Backup options:

■ *Jennifer Aniston spotted kissing new boyfriend on Spanish yacht*

The Angle: *After months of dating quietly, Jennifer Aniston and hypnotist Jim Curtis are publicly affectionate—and the internet is already weighing in on whether this relationship has real staying power.*

- **Jennifer Aniston** was spotted making out with boyfriend **Jim Curtis** during a yacht vacation off **Spain's coast**
- **Curtis** is a **hypnotist** (not your typical celebrity-dating profile)
- The couple was vacationing **with friends**, suggesting things are getting serious enough for group trips

The Relationship Read

- Is this the Jennifer Aniston relationship that actually sticks, or are we setting ourselves up for heartbreak again?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Hypnotist Question** - Quick host riff -> One host jokes: 'A hypnotist? So he literally puts people under a spell for a living—is that Jennifer's type, or is he just using his powers on her?' Other host responds with the romantic vs. skeptical take.
- **Step 2: The Aniston Relationship Pattern** - Caller challenge -> Open the lines: 'Listeners—do you think Jen's finally found her guy, or should we all just enjoy the yacht pics and not get attached? Call in your prediction.'

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/celebrity-news/bikini-clad-jennifer-aniston-and-boyfriend-jim-curtis-make-out-during-yacht-getaway/

■ *Aaron Rodgers credits his mystery wife for recent family reunion after years of estrangement*

The Angle: *Aaron Rodgers credits his mystery wife for recent family reunion after years of estrangement*

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 54/90 (25 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/celebrity-news/aaron-rodgers-credits-his-mystery-wife-for-recent-family-reunion-after-years-of-estrangement/

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Major B.C. wildfire doubles overnight—5,000 evacuated in 24 hours*

The Angle: *A rapidly expanding wildfire near Okanagan Lake has forced mass evacuations across British Columbia, with authorities warning the situation is escalating fast. This is a developing crisis affecting thousands of residents in real time.*

- The **Okanagan Lake wildfire has doubled in size** over a short period
- **More than 5,000 people** have been evacuated across B.C. in the past **24 hours alone**
- **Cliff Chapman**, B.C.'s director of wildfire operations, made the announcement at a Sunday news conference

The Reality Check

- If you're in B.C. right now—are you watching this spread in your area, or have you had to leave?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/okanagan-lake-wildfire-doubles-in-size-new-evacuations-ordered-9.7294464?cmp=rss

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■ *Canadian athletes bid farewell to 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow*

The Angle: *Canadian athletes bid farewell to 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/commonwealthgames/livestory/commonwealth-games-day-10-aug2-9.7294422?cmp=rss

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■ *Stuck ships in Hormuz could unleash invasive species crisis*

The Angle: *Hundreds of vessels blocked in the Persian Gulf aren't just piling up—they're becoming floating petri dishes. Scientists warn that months of buildup on ship hulls could trigger a massive invasive species invasion with real ecosystem consequences.*

- Ships stalled due to **Strait of Hormuz blockade** are accumulating **biofouling** (algae, barnacles, organisms) on their hulls over **several months**
- Experts describe the threat as **'immense'** and a **'worst-case scenario'** for marine ecosystems
- **Hundreds of vessels** are currently affected in the Gulf region
- A **paper published last week** documents how biofouling could spread **invasive species** when ships eventually resume movement

The Hidden Crisis

- How many of you knew that sitting ships could basically become biological weapons for ocean invasion?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/hormuz-invasive-species-super-spreader-9.7293025?cmp=rss

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■ *Dodgers land Cy Young ace Skubal ahead of playoff push*

The Angle: *The two-time defending World Series champs just added a **two-time Cy Young Award winner** to an already stacked rotation—a deadline move that signals the Dodgers are going all-in for another title run and reshapes the playoff landscape across baseball.*

- **Tarik Skubal**, a **two-time Cy Young Award winner**, has been traded to the **Los Angeles Dodgers**
- The Dodgers are **two-time defending World Series champions**
- **Wandy Peralta** was also traded, heading to the **Tampa Bay Rays** as part of the deadline shuffle

The Hot Take

- Does adding a generational pitcher like Skubal guarantee the Dodgers a third straight title, or is it overkill when you're already loaded?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/baseball/mlb/mlb-trade-deadline-roundup-aug-2-9.7294676?cmp=rss

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■■ *Languages can disappear through migration. Here's how immigrant families hope to save them*

The Angle: *Languages can disappear through migration. Here's how immigrant families hope to save them*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/sunday/migration-language-loss-9.7287384?cmp=rss

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■ *Ariana Grande bows out of London musical, taking a break*

The Angle: *The pop superstar is stepping back from her highly publicized life—including her starring role in a West End production—citing burnout and the need for privacy. It's a rare moment of a major celebrity openly prioritizing mental health over a guaranteed paycheck.*

- **Ariana Grande** has withdrawn from a **London musical** role
- She cited a need for a **'much-deserved break from public-facing work and appearances'**
- The move signals a shift toward privacy and stepping away from the spotlight

The Real Talk

- Should A-list celebrities be able to walk away from major contracts when burnout hits, or is that a luxury regular workers don't get?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/entertainment/celebrity/ariana-grande-withdraws-from-london-musical-seeks-to-step-back

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■■ *City warns of fake ticket scams after offering free ferry rides to Toronto Islands*

The Angle: *City warns of fake ticket scams after offering free ferry rides to Toronto Islands*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/local-news/warning-fake-toronto-island-ferry-tickets

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FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Firefighters rescue man from s–tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 26 banked (+15 each when found)
- "'Cats: The Jellicle Ball' Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars' favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Google Images Is Trying to Be… Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)
- "'Goodbye, Lara' Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You'll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)

- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: ‘Your love will forever be woven into who we are’" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)
- "‘Scrubs’ Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I’m Buying During Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘La La Land’ 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling’s Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘Harry Potter’ Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature ‘Sorcerer’s Stone’ 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC’s ‘Happy’s Place’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here’s How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band’s 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said ‘Absolutely No Goddamn AI’ in ‘Pan’s Labyrinth’ 3D Re-Release: ‘We’re Protecting a Lineage of Art’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah’s ‘favorites’ at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from ‘ultra-flattering’ pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "‘Star Trek: Starfleet Academy’ Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "‘Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror’ Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of ‘Jesus Christ Superstar’ After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 10 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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